



MICHAEL PHELPS

AP

Michael Phelps has an unprecedented tally of 28 medals — 23 gold — that he owes to his mother Debbie and none else. As a child, Phelps was diagnosed with Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD), and it was the timely intervention of his mother that later gave the world the medal-making machine we know. When he was just seven, with his mother cajoling him to not give up, Phelps did put in a ton of work in the pool, often swimming an astounding 80km every other week. Offsetting his disappointment in Sydney (just a fifth-place finish in the 200m butterfly),

Phelps took Athens 2004 by storm, picking eight medals, six of them gold. Beijing 2008 will remain the highpoint of his career as Phelps won gold in each of his eight events. London 2012, too, was profitable as he garnered a further six medals, four of them gold. And then, finally came Rio 2016 as Phelps re-emerged from retirement to stack up five more golds and a silver. Larisa Latynina's benchmark of 18 medals, gained between Melbourne 1956 and Tokyo 1964, that had stood for 48 long years looked a pale shadow by the time Phelps finally bid hurrah.